

User Handbook for the Customer Portal

The customer portal bundles everything to do with your user account: sign-in, password management, billing, support and your personal settings. This handbook describes each area and the rules that apply there. The ten chapters below walk through the features you use most often in the portal, in the order you are likely to meet them.

1. Signing in

Access to the customer portal is protected by an email address and a personal password. You enter both on the sign-in page; after that the portal is fully available to you. For security reasons, every account is locked temporarily after several failed sign-in attempts, so that nobody can guess the password by trying. The lock lifts automatically; there is no need to notify support.

- Sign-in with email address and password
- After three failed attempts the account is locked for 15 minutes
- The lock lifts automatically

1.1 How do I recognise a lock?

When an account is locked, a notice with the remaining wait time appears on the sign-in attempt. Wait that time out and then sign in again. If you have forgotten the password in the meantime, chapter 2 will help.

2. Resetting your password

If you no longer know your password, a "Forgot password" link is available on the sign-in page. After selecting the link you enter the email address stored on your account. The system then sends a message containing a link through which you can set a new password. That link is deliberately short-lived: it expires after 30 minutes. If the email does not arrive within a few minutes, please check your spam folder before starting the process again.

- "Forgot password" link on the sign-in page
- Enter the email address of the account
- The reset link is valid for 30 minutes

2.1 What happens once the link has expired?

After the deadline the link leads to an error message. Simply request a new link through the same page; there is no limit on how often you may do so.

3. Two-factor authentication

Two-factor authentication secures your account further. In addition to the password, the portal then asks for a second proof that an attacker cannot simply read off. The feature is enabled in the account settings. The options are authenticator apps on your smartphone and one-time codes sent by email. Setting up an authenticator app is considered the safer variant, because the code never leaves the device.

- Enabled in the account settings

- Authenticator apps and one-time codes by email are supported
- Recommendation: use an authenticator app

3.1 What if the second device is lost?

If the smartphone is lost, signing in is not possible at first. In that case contact support, who reset the two-factor authentication after an identity check.

4. Invoices

You will find all invoices for your contract in the "Billing" menu. They are available there to download as PDF files, so that you can save, print or pass them on to your accounting department. Invoices remain available in the customer portal for five years. Download important receipts in good time if you want to keep them longer.

- "Billing" menu
- Download as a PDF file
- Retention in the portal: five years

4.1 Can I still find older invoices?

After the five years have passed, invoices are removed from the portal. If you need an older receipt, support can usually supply it for a processing fee.

5. Support

Support is there to help with questions and faults. It is reachable Monday to Friday from 08:00 to 18:00. The easiest way to submit a request is through the contact form in the customer portal; that way your account details are already on file and processing is faster. Requests outside service hours are handled on the next working day.

- Service hours: Monday to Friday, 08:00 to 18:00
- Contact form in the customer portal
- Requests outside those hours are handled on the next working day

5.1 Which details help with a request?

Please state your customer number, the area concerned and a short description in the form. Screenshots speed up the resolution of technical problems.

6. Editing your user profile

You maintain your personal details in the "My profile" menu. There you can change your name, phone number and preferred language. The preferred language determines the language in which you receive notifications and notices from the portal. For security reasons a change of email address does not take effect immediately: the system sends a confirmation link to the new address, valid for 24 hours. Only after confirmation is the change applied.

6.1 Why is the email address confirmed separately?

The email address serves both as your sign-in name and as the recipient of security notices. Confirmation makes sure the address really belongs to you and that a typo has not addressed someone else's mailbox.

7. Notifications

In the "Notifications" menu you decide which messages you want to receive. The options are email notifications and notices inside the portal; both channels can be configured independently of each other. Security-relevant messages, for instance about sign-ins or password changes, cannot be fully disabled. This exception protects your account: you should notice if somebody else tries to gain access to it.

- Choice between email and portal notifications
- Both channels configurable independently
- Security-relevant messages cannot be fully disabled

7.1 What counts as a security-relevant message?

This includes notices about sign-ins from new devices, about password and email changes, and about account locks. These messages always reach you through the contact channel on file.

8. Uploading documents

In the "Documents" area you can store your own files and make them available to support or case handlers. The formats PDF, PNG and JPG are supported; the maximum file size is 10 MB. Please split larger files or convert them into a more compact PDF. Uploaded documents can be deleted again within 30 days. After that the system removes them automatically.

- Formats: PDF, PNG and JPG
- Maximum file size: 10 MB
- Deletion possible within 30 days

8.1 Why is my document not accepted?

It is usually the file size or the format. Check the details above the file picker; for a different format, convert the file first, for instance with a PDF export from your word processor.

9. Deactivating your user account

If you no longer wish to use the portal, the account can be deactivated under "Account settings". After deactivation signing in is no longer possible, but the stored data is retained at first. Within 14 days support can restore the account if you change your mind. Once that period has passed the account is deleted for good; restoration is then no longer possible.

- Deactivation under "Account settings"
- No sign-in after deactivation
- Restoration by support within 14 days
- After that, final deletion

9.1 What happens to my invoices when the account is deleted?

Deleting the account for good also removes access to the invoices stored in the portal. Download receipts you still need beforehand.

10. Data protection and session duration

The portal ends a session automatically after 20 minutes without activity. This protection prevents an unattended computer from leaving access open. If you work on a public or shared device, sign out manually as well. You can export your personal data in the data protection area. Depending on the volume of stored details, producing the export can take up to 24 hours; you will be notified as soon as the data is ready.

- Automatic sign-out after 20 minutes without activity
- Data export available in the data protection area
- Producing the export takes up to 24 hours

10.1 For which reasons is a session ended?

Beyond inactivity, a session ends when you sign out, when the browser is closed in some configurations, and on a password change. In every case signing in again is required.

Glossary

- Customer portal: the web application in which you manage your account.
- Session: the period between signing in and signing out.
- Two-factor authentication: signing in with a password and a second proof.
- Authenticator app: a program on your smartphone that generates one-time codes.